Ancient Philosophy

- Lecture 3
- From the Presocratics to Aristotle

The Presocratics

- Thales: everything is water
- Heraclitus: everything flows
- Parmenides: change is an illusion

Socrates and the Elenchus

- The Socratic method of questioning
- Know thyself
- The unexamined life is not worth living

Plato: The Theory of Forms

- Forms are perfect abstract realities
- The allegory of the cave
- Justice in the Republic

Plato vs Aristotle on the Forms

- Aristotle rejected separate Forms
- Form exists in matter
- Hylomorphism

Aristotle: Virtue Ethics

- Eudaimonia is the highest good
- Virtue is a mean between extremes
- Habituation builds character

Hellenistic Schools

- Stoicism
- Epicureanism
- Skepticism